

Redendron
Media

Creating an Experiential Travel Brand from Scratch

THE CONTEXT

In 2023, Offbeat Sikkim, a travel agency, embarked on a full strategic and visual rebrand. They were helping travelers curate unique trips and treks across Sikkim, while providing a glimpse the local culture and heritage.



THE PROBLEM

Offbeat Sikkim lacked a solid brand foundations, making it challenging to distinguish themselves in Sikkim's highly competitive tourism market.

THE OBJECTIVE

To position Offbeat Sikkim as the premier provider of experiential travel in Sikkim by developing a strategic brand and visual identity, and promoting offbeat tourism through an effective social media strategy.

1. EMPATHISE 2. CONCEPTUALISE 3. DESIGN

1. EMPATHISE 2 3

We knew our mission but we lacked insight from important stakeholders

- Current frustrations and pain points?
- What did they really want?
- What did they really need?



1. EMPATHISE 2 3

Conducted intensive research on the audience and competition

- Conducted Stakeholder Interviews
- Built User Personas
- Prepared an Empathy Map Canvas





Name:
Abishek Pandey

Age:
28 years old

Behavioural Demographics:

Abishek is originally from South India who co-owns a B2C Shoe comforter
called "Comfee". Since his company head quarters is in Bangalore he has
there. Back home, his parents live with his daughter in a rented apartment
completed his MBA very enthusiastically in hopes of creating a young entr
success story of his own. He works flexible hours but mostly he is in his o
since he takes care of sales and heads product development. His compan
receive a concrete financial evaluation but he receives quarterly dividends
around Rs.1-1.5 lacs every quarter.

Our Customer

User Persona

- Abhishek, owner of shoe business lives in Bangalore. He mostly finds himself needing headspace to think clearly about his business, and to wind down.
- He also seems to find himself needing an escape from the daily grind and wants to visit places where he'd feel closer to nature.
- He is overwhelmed by city life and fears losing his youth to his business, worrying he may not have time to travel later.

Empathy Map

1. WHO are we empathizing with?

- Abishek Pandey
- He is a South Indian Lives and works in Bangalore.
- 27 Years Old, Partially owns a B2P Shoe comforter company.ca
- His income is 40-50k per month, collects quarterly dividends from his corp
- An Entr... looking ... workati...

2. What do they need to DO?

- Get enough sales for his business, track finances, talk to clients or custom...
- He needs to be able to create work-life balance and avoid burnout w...
- He needs more creativity and ideas to outstand his brand.
- He needs to wake up early, go to work, answer emails, manage his...
- He needs a better marketing strategy and sometimes he thinks with li...

Empathy Map Canvas

- **User Emotions and Actions:** Detailed mapping of user emotions and actions to understand their full response spectrum.
- **Pain Points and Gains:** Identified key user pain points and gains to guide user-centric feature development.
- **Holistic View:** Achieved a comprehensive view of user experiences, enhancing the design of empathetic interactions.

THINK and FEEL?

Gains (wants, needs, hopes, dream...

- He wants more from his life, wants to r...
- He thinks he needs a refreshing tour to s...
- He needs to be able to provide for his fa...
- He also wants to build ...wn Bungalow
- He hopes he can go to stay at Sikkim at l...
- He needs a vacation to just chill and relax.
- He hopes to establish a solid business
- He wants to scale his business.

3. What do they SEE?

- They see their competitor brands trying to gain market share
- People from all over the world coming to Bangalore to connect and...
- He has been reading Personal MBA, likes to check out The Economic Ti...
- He sees an opportunity to expand his business as he's rece...
- He sees lots of tech stuf and IOT markets flourishing. Most of his friends...

- He hea... digital ... lifestyl... taking ...
- He hea... the com... brand
- During work hours he mostly hears about business, tech and news. At h...

1. EMPATHISE

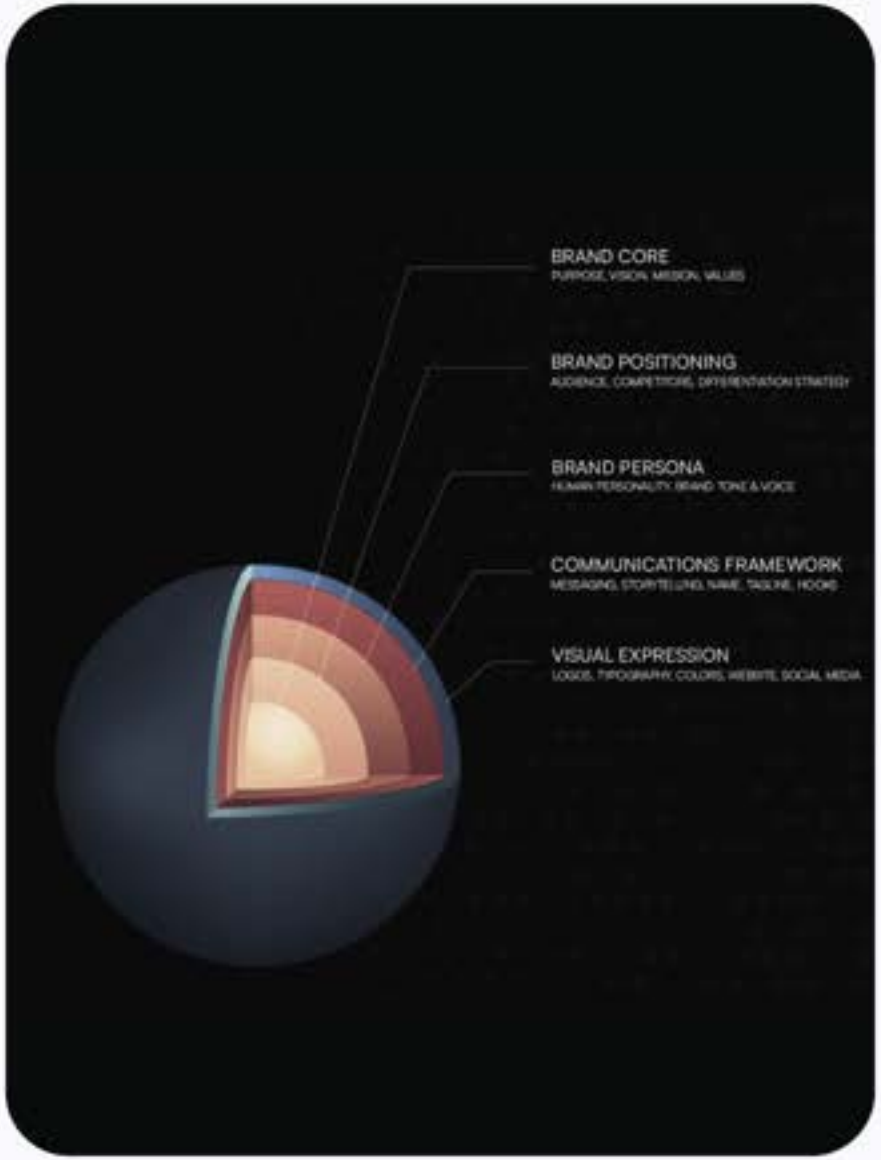
2. CONCEPTUALISE

3. DESIGN

1 **2. CONCEPTUALISE** 3

We started creating a roadmap for the brand strategy & identity development

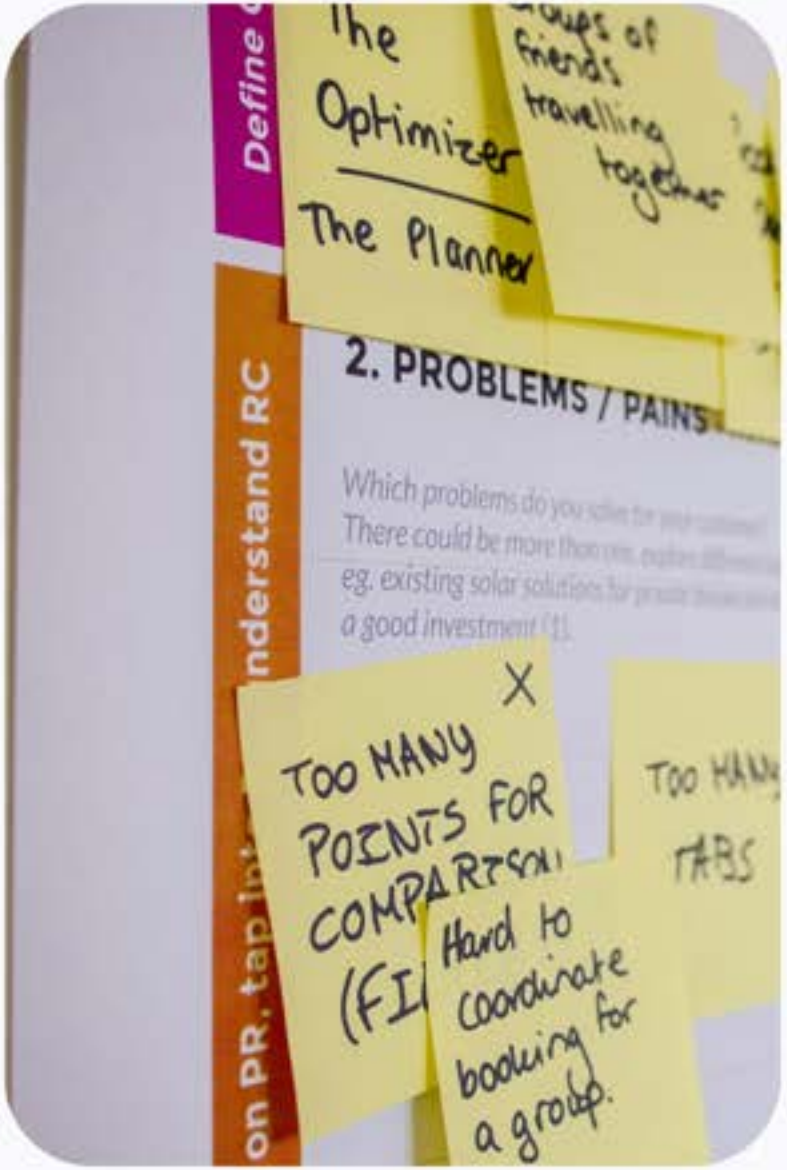
- Initial Competitor Research
- Brand Persona & Identity Mood Boards
- Preliminary Communications Framework



1 **2. CONCEPTUALISE** 3

Started secondary research to start executing the roadmap

- Comprehensive Competitive Audit
- Customer Experience & Journey Mapping
- Development of Offer Prototypes



Offbeat Sikkim

Requirements

Comprehensive competitive audit

Approaching the market with the same or very similar options to what's already out there will work against Offbeat Sikkim. We've already completed some research on our competitors which has given us

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Competitive Audit

- **Brand Differentiation:** Identified a market gap in highlighting Sikkim's unique cultural and natural landscapes, positioning Offbeat Sikkim distinctively among competitors focused on popular spots.
- **Website and Social Media Analysis:** Assessed competitor websites and social media, leading to a strategy for Offbeat Sikkim that emphasizes high-quality visuals and content to attract adventure and culture-focused travelers.

Insights

- Our industry is dominated by a few brands who take the buying experience and customer journey seriously. Most travel agencies blend in with the noise in the marketplace and hit saturation.
- Our biggest competitors locally and globally include brands like Ourguest and Thrillophilia. Differentiating ourselves from similar competitors would require us to understand the unmet needs of our customers and the gaps that our competitors are leaving open.
- The market is dominated by well established companies. While this is challenging, a modern approach with unified brand messaging and visual direction may offer our audience a new perspective on travel planning when compared to their existing market options.

Competitive Landscape

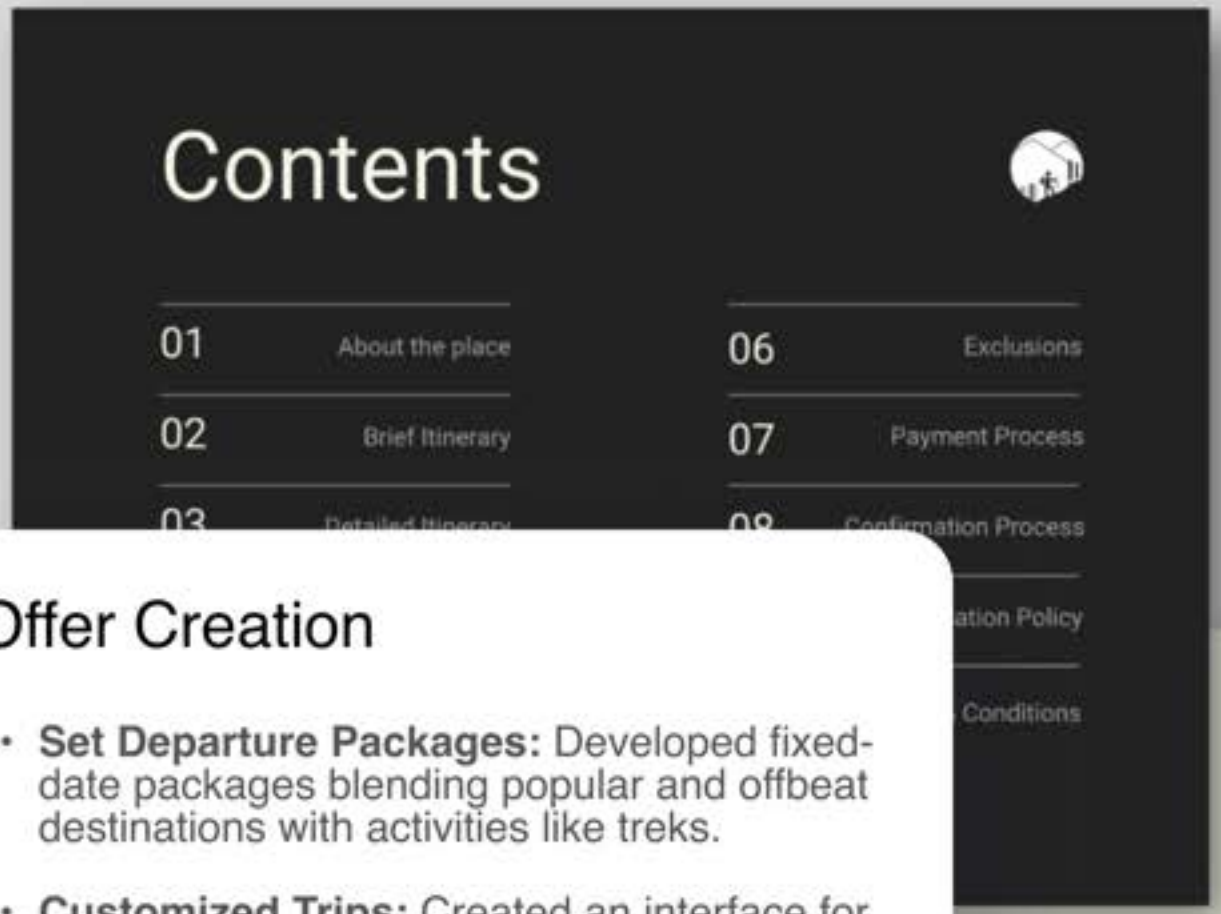


User Journey Mapping

Path to Discovery: Outlined the customer journey from awareness to decision-making, focusing on engaging and informative touchpoints that highlight Offbeat Sikkim's unique offerings.

Engagement Touchpoints: Implemented various interactive and informative touchpoints, including customizable trip interfaces and personalized content on Sikkim's lesser-known destinations.

Conversion Strategies: Streamlined the enquiry and booking process to minimize steps and used persuasive content to expedite decision-making.







Offer Creation

- **Set Departure Packages:** Developed fixed-date packages blending popular and offbeat destinations with activities like treks.
- **Customized Trips:** Created an interface for travelers to tailor trips according to their preferences & interests.
- **Feedback Incorporation:** Refined travel options based on user group feedback and testing.

1. EMPATHISE 2. CONCEPTUALISE 3. DESIGN

1 2 **3. DESIGN**

There was a lot that needed to get done. Where would we start?

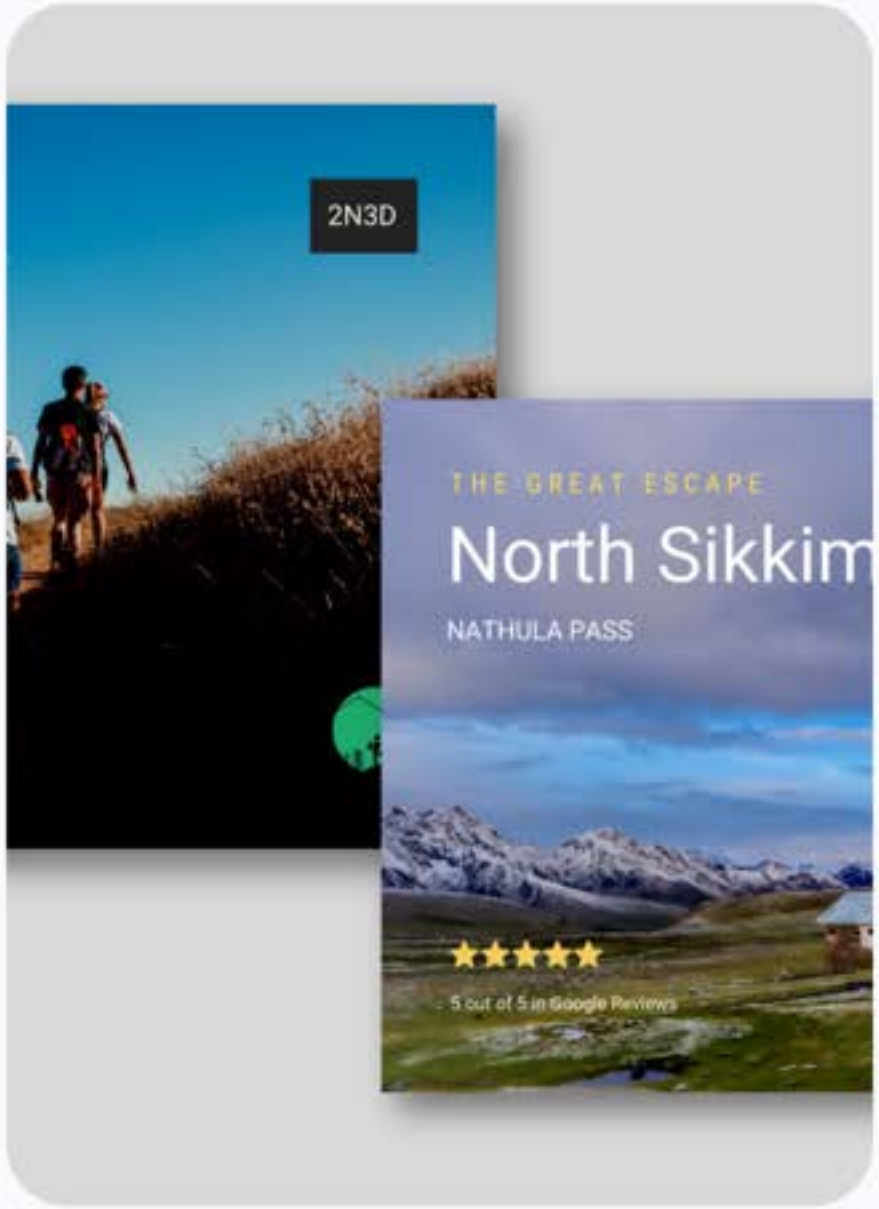
- With the tourist season approaching, should we skip over brand strategy and focus on getting the logo ready?
- Should we force build the website in 3 weeks while compromising on quality?
- Without a visual identity system and guidelines, how would we market our offers?

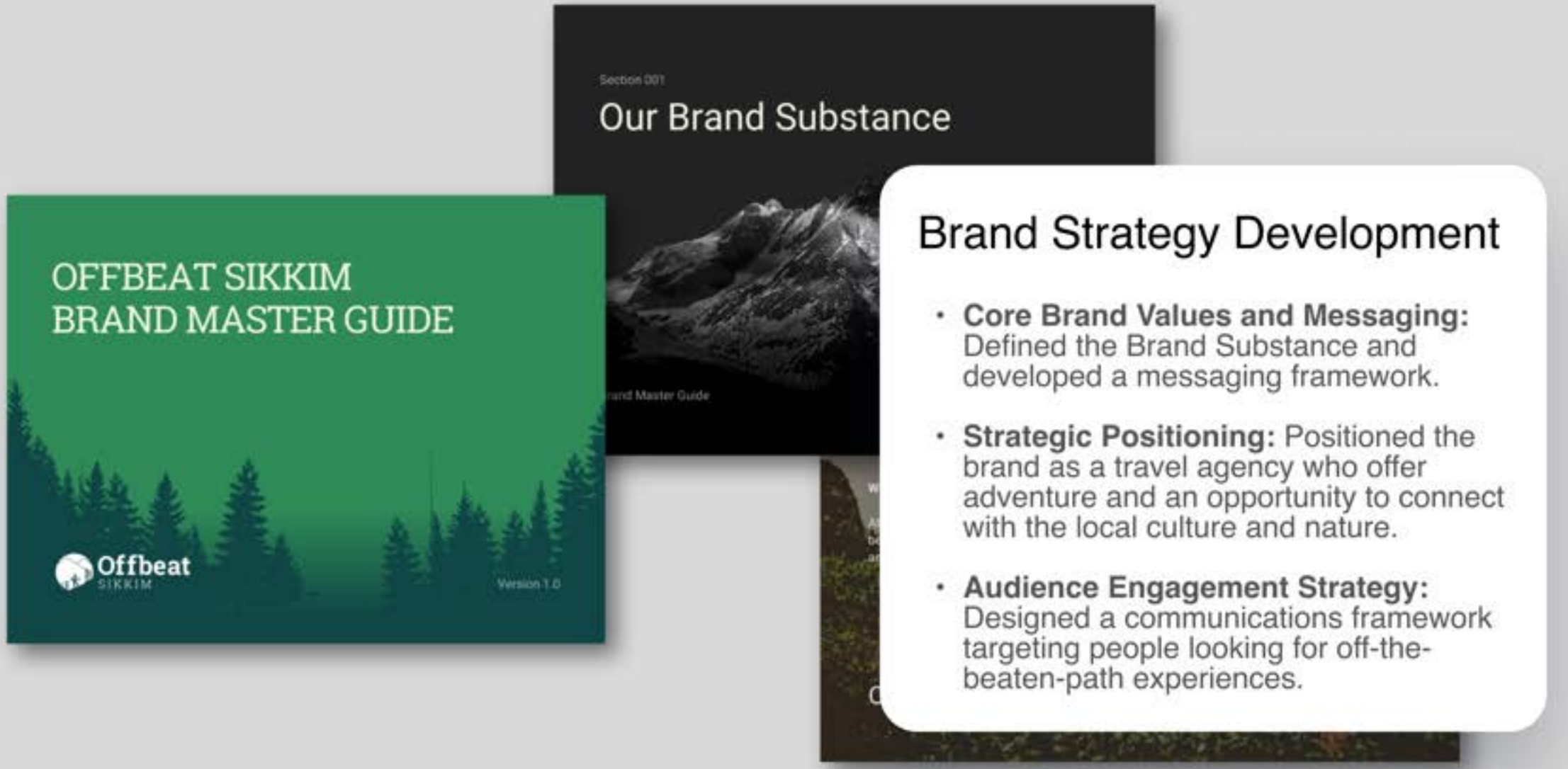


1 2 **3. DESIGN**

Once we answered the burning questions, we commenced design right away.

- Took the brand strategy & identity parallelly
- Built the website in the background
- Created a content strategy as soon as the visual identity was prepared




OFFBEAT SIKKIM
BRAND MASTER GUIDE
Offbeat
SIKKIM
Version 1.0
Section 001
Our Brand Substance
Brand Strategy Development
• Core Brand Values and Messaging: Defined the Brand Substance and developed a messaging framework.
• Strategic Positioning: Positioned the brand as a travel agency who offer adventure and an opportunity to connect with the local culture and nature.
• Audience Engagement Strategy: Designed a communications framework targeting people looking for off-the-beaten-path experiences.

Visual Identity System

- **Logo and Brand Elements:** Developed a logo that reflects Sikkim's natural beauty and cultural heritage.
- **Color Palette and Typography:** Adopted a color palette inspired by the natural surroundings of Sikkim—lush greens and vibrant accents.
- **Style Guide:** Created a style guide that contains logo, color and typography rules that ensure consistency and protect the brand's visual integrity across all platforms and settings.

Offbeat SIKKIM

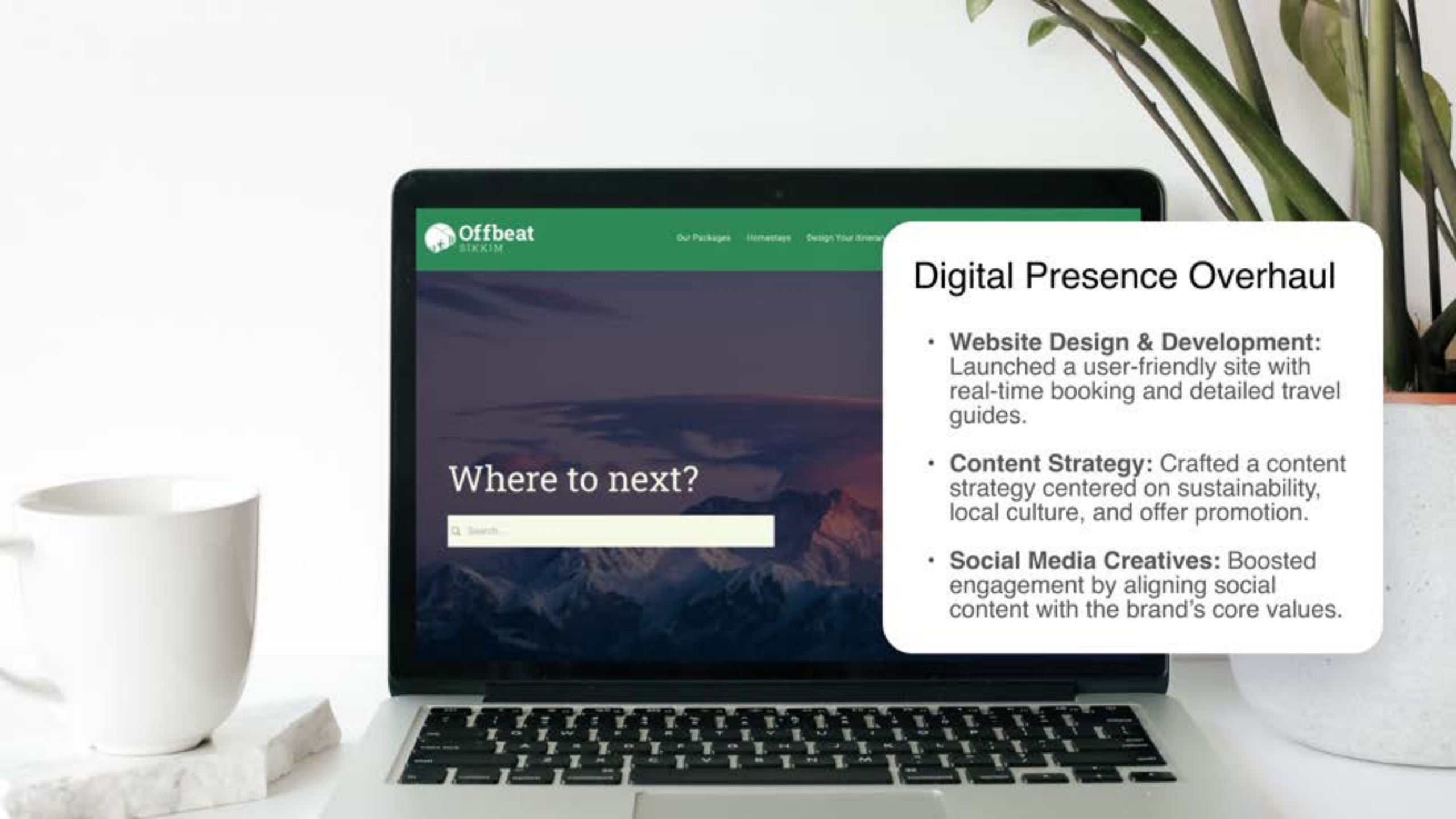
Primary Lockup

Icon-Only

Offbeat SIKKIM

Wordmark Lockup





Digital Presence Overhaul

- **Website Design & Development:** Launched a user-friendly site with real-time booking and detailed travel guides.
- **Content Strategy:** Crafted a content strategy centered on sustainability, local culture, and offer promotion.
- **Social Media Creatives:** Boosted engagement by aligning social content with the brand's core values.

OUTCOMES

We publicised the rebrand, which got a lot of immediate positive feedback from the target audience

Wins

- Following the rebrand, our social media efforts led to massive growth in engagement, with particular success noted from informative content and user-generated posts.
- The new website showed ~50% increase every month in traffic with longer session durations. At least 20-30 bookings were recorded through the website without paid ads.
- Their goal of >$30,000 in revenue for the first year was surpassed in just 75 days, thanks to the fresh rebrand, consistent social media content, effective direct response ads and ongoing website conversion optimization.

Losses

- While website traffic increased, the initial conversion rate for bookings was lower than expected, suggesting further need to optimize the user journey and reassess the calls-to-action on the website.
- Encountered challenges with maintaining booking rates during off-peak seasons, indicating a need for a system that guarantees a steady stream of leads during off-season periods.

Learnings

- The use of consistent messaging and visuals across all platforms played a crucial role in building brand recognition and trust with our target audience.
- Focusing on engaging content and interactive social media strategies helped in building a community around the brand, which is crucial for long-term success.
- Ongoing analysis and optimization of Website UX and social media strategies are essential to improve conversions and adapt to changing user preferences and market conditions.